



Using Apache Xampp and PHP on Windows

Apache Xampp is an open source tool used for running PHP or PERL Web applications locally using a Web server. It is available for all major operating systems and is popular with Windows users to locally build and test their Web apps. In this tutorial, we will explore how to get started with Xampp. In the process, we shall create and run our own Web application in PHP, and use MySQL databases with the help of the PHPMyAdmin tool.

Xampp is a free and open source cross-platform Web server solution stack package developed by Apache Friends. It comes loaded with an Apache HTTP server, MariaDB, and MySQL. It also has interpreters for the programming languages PHP and PERL. Xampp is one of the most popular solutions for running PHP apps locally on Windows. Pronounced as *Shamp*, it is an abbreviation for ‘cross-platform MySQL PHP and Perl’.

In this article, we will explore how to use Xampp from scratch. We will start by downloading and installing it. We will then run a simple PHP Web application on a local host and use the PHPMyAdmin tool to utilise the MySQL database.

Downloading Xampp

Downloading Xampp is super easy and does not require any special instructions. Simply Google ‘Xampp’ and click on the first link. Then click the *Download* button for Windows. This should download a .exe file on your computer. Upon completion of the download, run the executable file.

Installing Xampp

Upon opening the executable file, you will see the installation window on your screen, as shown in Figure 1. Click *Next* and begin the installation. You will be asked to select the components to install. You can either select and install all the components of the package, or install only the ones that you require. For the sake of this tutorial, it is necessary to select PHP, MySQL, Apache, and PHPMyAdmin. For simplicity, we have selected and installed all the components, as seen in Figure 2.



Figure 1: Open setup

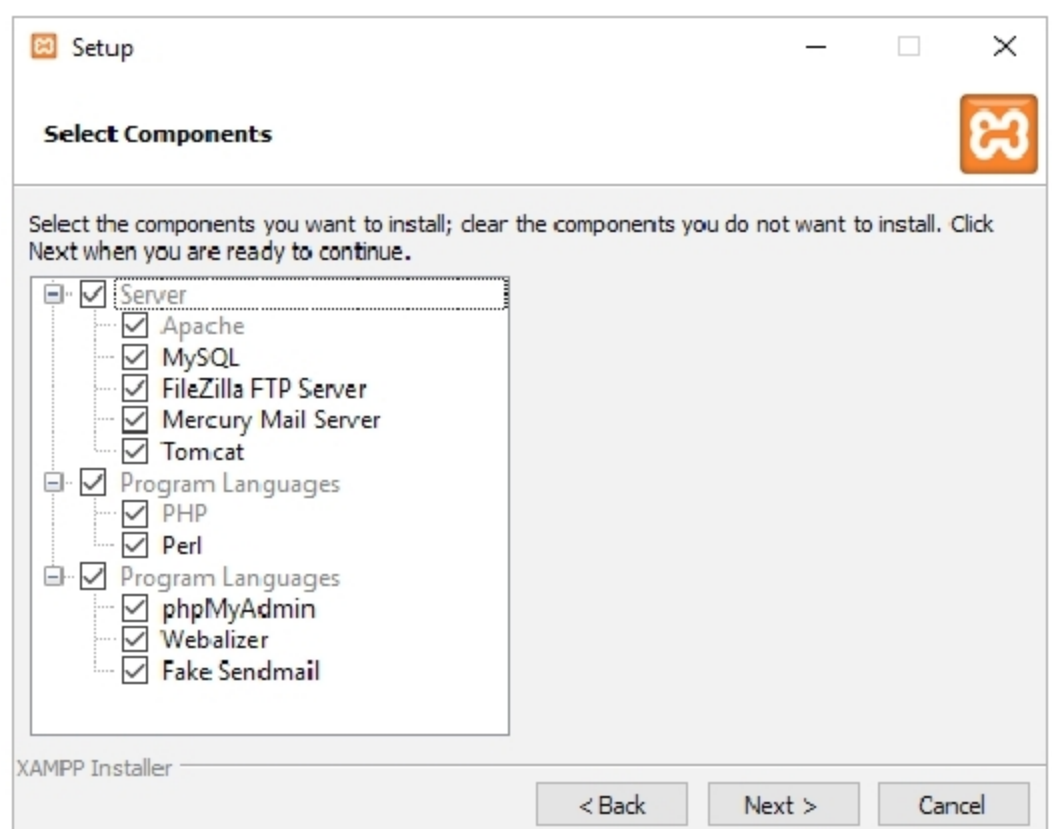


Figure 2: Selecting the components to install

